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United States Patent	12398920
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
Inventor(s)	Wilson; Stephen C. et al.

HVAC system with baffles

Abstract

A furnace for a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system includes a first set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within an air flow path of the furnace through which an air flow may be directed, a second set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within the air flow path of the furnace, and a deflector baffle positioned within the air flow path and configured to direct a portion of the air flow toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes. The first set of heat exchanger tubes, the deflector baffle, and the second set of heat exchanger tubes are each respectively offset from one another in a direction of the air flow along the air flow path.

Inventors: Wilson; Stephen C. (Oklahoma City, OK), Suryawanshi; Sumedh J. (Pune, IN), Chothave; Amit R. (Nashik, IN), Garg; Karan (Pune, IN)

Applicant: Johnson Controls Tyco IP Holdings LLP (Milwaukee, WI)

Family ID: 1000008780678

Assignee: JOHNSON CONTROLS LIGHT COMMERCIAL IP GMBH (Neuhausen am Rheinfall, CH)

Appl. No.: 18/369663

Filed: September 18, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240003593 A1	Jan. 04, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 16689843 20191120 US 11761679 child-doc US 18369663

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: F24H3/08 (20220101); F24H9/00 (20220101); F24H9/1881 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC F24H3/087 (20130101); F24H9/0063 (20130101); F24H9/1881 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

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Primary Examiner: Lau; Jason

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Fletcher Yoder, PC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/689,843, entitled “HVAC SYSTEM WITH BAFFLES,” filed Nov. 20, 2019, which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

(1) This section is intended to introduce the reader to various aspects of art that may be related to various aspects of the present disclosure, which are described below. This discussion is believed to be helpful in providing the reader with background information to facilitate a better understanding of the various aspects of the present disclosure. Accordingly, it should be noted that these statements are to be read in this light, and not as admissions of prior art.

(2) HVAC systems are utilized in residential, commercial, and industrial environments to control environmental properties, such as temperature and humidity, for occupants of the respective

environments. An HVAC system may control the environmental properties through control of an air flow delivered to the environment. For example, the HVAC system may circulate a refrigerant and place the refrigerant in a heat exchange relationship with a supply air flow to condition the supply air flow before it is discharged to the conditioned environment. In some embodiments, the HVAC system includes a heat exchanger through which the refrigerant or other working fluid flows. For example, the heat exchanger may be a furnace configured to direct combustion products through tubes of the furnace. The supply air flow may be directed over the heat exchanger to exchange heat with the refrigerant or other working fluid. However, in some instances, a portion of the supply air flow may not flow directly across or through the heat exchanger. As such, an amount of heat exchanged between the supply air flow and the refrigerant or working fluid is reduced, thereby impacting a performance, such as an efficiency, of the HVAC system to condition the supply air flow.

SUMMARY

(3) A summary of certain embodiments disclosed herein is set forth below. It should be understood that these aspects are presented merely to provide the reader with a brief summary of these certain embodiments and that these aspects are not intended to limit the scope of this disclosure. Indeed, this disclosure may encompass a variety of aspects that may not be set forth below.

(4) In one embodiment, a furnace for a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system includes a first set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within an air flow path of the furnace through which an air flow may be directed, a second set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within the air flow path of the furnace, and a deflector baffle positioned within the air flow path and configured to direct a portion of the air flow toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes. The first set of heat exchanger tubes, the deflector baffle, and the second set of heat exchanger tubes are each respectively offset from one another in a direction of the air flow along the air flow path.

(5) In one embodiment, a furnace for a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system includes a first set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within an air flow path of the furnace through which an air flow may be directed, a second set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within the air flow path of the furnace and a deflector baffle positioned within the air flow path and between the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes relative to a direction of the air flow through the furnace.

(6) In one embodiment, a furnace for a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system includes a first set of heat exchanger tubes configured to heat an air flow, a second set of heat exchanger tubes configured to further heat the air flow, and a baffle positioned between the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes along a direction of the air flow through the furnace. The baffle has a deflecting surface configured to direct the air flow from the first set of heat exchanger tubes toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Various aspects of the present disclosure may be better understood upon reading the following detailed description and upon reference to the drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an embodiment of a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system for environmental management that may employ one or more HVAC units, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an embodiment of a packaged HVAC unit that may be used in the HVAC system of FIG. 1, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3 is a cutaway perspective view of an embodiment of a residential, split HVAC system, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;

- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic of an embodiment of a vapor compression system that can be used in any of the systems of FIGS. 1-3, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic of an embodiment of an HVAC unit having heat exchanger tubes and baffles, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a schematic of an embodiment of a section of an HVAC system having heat exchanger tubes and baffles, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a schematic of an embodiment of a section of an HVAC system having heat exchanger tubes, baffles, and a controller configured to actuate the baffles, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a schematic of an embodiment of a section of an HVAC system having heat exchanger tubes, baffles, and a controller configured to actuate the baffles, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure;
- (10) FIG. 9 is a schematic of an embodiment of a section of an HVAC system having heat exchanger tubes and baffles, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure; and
- (11) FIG. 10 is a schematic of an embodiment of a section of an HVAC system having heat exchanger tubes and baffles in a side discharge configuration, in accordance with an aspect of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) One or more specific embodiments will be described below. In an effort to provide a concise description of these embodiments, not all features of an actual implementation are described in the specification. It should be noted that in the development of any such actual implementation, as in any engineering or design project, numerous implementation-specific decisions must be made to achieve the developers' specific goals, such as compliance with system-related and business-related constraints, which may vary from one implementation to another. Moreover, it should be noted that such a development effort might be complex and time consuming, but would nevertheless be a routine undertaking of design, fabrication, and manufacture for those of ordinary skill having the benefit of this disclosure.

(13) When introducing elements of various embodiments of the present disclosure, the articles “a,” “an,” and “the” are intended to mean that there are one or more of the elements. The terms “comprising,” “including,” and “having” are intended to be inclusive and mean that there may be additional elements other than the listed elements. Additionally, it should be noted that references to “one embodiment” or “an embodiment” of the present disclosure are not intended to be interpreted as excluding the existence of additional embodiments that also incorporate the recited features.

(14) The present disclosure is directed to a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system having a section or chamber that includes a heat exchanger through which a working fluid is configured to flow. For example, the heat exchanger may be a furnace, and the working fluid may be combustion products. An air flow may be directed through the section to exchange heat with the working fluid, thereby conditioning the air flow. In some embodiments, the heat exchanger includes a first set of heat exchanger tubes and a second set of heat exchanger tubes positioned in series relative to a direction of the air flow through the section. In an embodiment in which the heat exchanger is a furnace of the HVAC system, heat from combustion products within the heat exchanger may transfer to the air flow to increase the temperature of the air flow. As such, the air flow may flow across the first set of heat exchanger tubes and exchange heat with the working fluid to heat the air flow, and the air flow may then flow across the second set of heat exchanger tubes and exchange heat with the working fluid to further heat the air flow.

(15) In some instances, the air flow directed through the section does not directly flow across the heat exchanger. As an example, a portion of the air flow may flow around or to the side of the first and/or the second set of heat exchanger tubes, rather than across the first and/or the second set of heat exchanger tubes. Thus, the portion of the air flow may not exchange heat with the working

fluid flowing through the heat exchanger tubes. As a result, an amount of heat exchanged between the working fluid and the air flow may be reduced, thereby causing insufficient conditioning of the air flow and/or inefficient operation of the HVAC system.

(16) Thus, it is now recognized that directing the air flow to flow directly across the heat exchanger may increase the amount of heat exchanged between the working fluid and the air flow.

Accordingly, embodiments of the present disclosure are directed to baffles or baffle plates positioned within the section so as to direct the air flow across the heat exchanger tubes. In some embodiments, the baffles are positioned between the first and second set of heat exchanger tubes and may guide the air flow from the first set of heat exchanger tubes to the second set of heat exchanger tubes. For instance, the baffles may be attached to respective walls of the section and may extend toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes to form an opening or flow path that directs the air flow toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes. As a result, the air flow may move through the opening and directly across the second set of heat exchanger tubes. For this reason, the baffles may increase the amount of heat exchanged between the air flow and the working fluid flowing through the second set of heat exchanger tubes, thereby improving a performance of the HVAC system to condition the air flow. Although the present disclosure primarily discusses implementation of the baffles within a furnace configured to increase the temperature of the air flow, the baffles may be disposed within any suitable section or chamber of the HVAC system through which the air flow is directed to guide the air flow through the section in a desirable manner.

(17) Turning now to the drawings, FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system for environmental management that may employ one or more HVAC units. As used herein, an HVAC system includes any number of components configured to enable regulation of parameters related to climate characteristics, such as temperature, humidity, air flow, pressure, air quality, and so forth. For example, an “HVAC system” as used herein is defined as conventionally understood and as further described herein. Components or parts of an “HVAC system” may include, but are not limited to, all, some of, or individual parts such as a heat exchanger, a heater, an air flow control device, such as a fan, a sensor configured to detect a climate characteristic or operating parameter, a filter, a control device configured to regulate operation of an HVAC system component, a component configured to enable regulation of climate characteristics, or a combination thereof. An “HVAC system” is a system configured to provide such functions as heating, cooling, ventilation, dehumidification, pressurization, refrigeration, filtration, or any combination thereof. The embodiments described herein may be utilized in a variety of applications to control climate characteristics, such as residential, commercial, industrial, transportation, or other applications where climate control is desired.

(18) In the illustrated embodiment, a building **10** is air conditioned by a system that includes an HVAC unit **12**. The building **10** may be a commercial structure or a residential structure. As shown, the HVAC unit **12** is disposed on the roof of the building **10**; however, the HVAC unit **12** may be located in other equipment rooms or areas adjacent the building **10**. The HVAC unit **12** may be a single package unit containing other equipment, such as a blower, integrated air handler, and/or auxiliary heating unit. In other embodiments, the HVAC unit **12** may be part of a split HVAC system, such as the system shown in FIG. 3, which includes an outdoor HVAC unit **58** and an indoor HVAC unit **56**.

(19) The HVAC unit **12** is an air cooled device that implements a refrigeration cycle to provide conditioned air to the building **10**. Specifically, the HVAC unit **12** may include one or more heat exchangers across which an air flow is passed to condition the air flow before the air flow is supplied to the building. In the illustrated embodiment, the HVAC unit **12** is a rooftop unit (RTU) that conditions a supply air stream, such as environmental air and/or a return air flow from the building **10**. After the HVAC unit **12** conditions the air, the air is supplied to the building **10** via ductwork **14** extending throughout the building **10** from the HVAC unit **12**. For example, the

ductwork **14** may extend to various individual floors or other sections of the building **10**. In certain embodiments, the HVAC unit **12** may be a heat pump that provides both heating and cooling to the building with one refrigeration circuit configured to operate in different modes. In other embodiments, the HVAC unit **12** may include one or more refrigeration circuits for cooling an air stream and a furnace for heating the air stream.

(20) A control device **16**, one type of which may be a thermostat, may be used to designate the temperature of the conditioned air. The control device **16** also may be used to control the flow of air through the ductwork **14**. For example, the control device **16** may be used to regulate operation of one or more components of the HVAC unit **12** or other components, such as dampers and fans, within the building **10** that may control flow of air through and/or from the ductwork **14**. In some embodiments, other devices may be included in the system, such as pressure and/or temperature transducers or switches that sense the temperatures and pressures of the supply air, return air, and so forth. Moreover, the control device **16** may include computer systems that are integrated with or separate from other building control or monitoring systems, and even systems that are remote from the building **10**.

(21) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an embodiment of the HVAC unit **12**. In the illustrated embodiment, the HVAC unit **12** is a single package unit that may include one or more independent refrigeration circuits and components that are tested, charged, wired, piped, and ready for installation. The HVAC unit **12** may provide a variety of heating and/or cooling functions, such as cooling only, heating only, cooling with electric heat, cooling with dehumidification, cooling with gas heat, or cooling with a heat pump. As described above, the HVAC unit **12** may directly cool and/or heat an air stream provided to the building **10** to condition a space in the building **10**.

(22) As shown in the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 2, a cabinet **24** encloses the HVAC unit **12** and provides structural support and protection to the internal components from environmental and other contaminants. In some embodiments, the cabinet **24** may be constructed of galvanized steel and insulated with aluminum foil faced insulation. Rails **26** may be joined to the bottom perimeter of the cabinet **24** and provide a foundation for the HVAC unit **12**. In certain embodiments, the rails **26** may provide access for a forklift and/or overhead rigging to facilitate installation and/or removal of the HVAC unit **12**. In some embodiments, the rails **26** may fit into “curbs” on the roof to enable the HVAC unit **12** to provide air to the ductwork **14** from the bottom of the HVAC unit **12** while blocking elements such as rain from leaking into the building **10**.

(23) The HVAC unit **12** includes heat exchangers **28** and **30** in fluid communication with one or more refrigeration circuits. Tubes within the heat exchangers **28** and **30** may circulate refrigerant, such as R-410A, through the heat exchangers **28** and **30**. The tubes may be of various types, such as multichannel tubes, conventional copper or aluminum tubing, and so forth. Together, the heat exchangers **28** and **30** may implement a thermal cycle in which the refrigerant undergoes phase changes and/or temperature changes as it flows through the heat exchangers **28** and **30** to produce heated and/or cooled air. For example, the heat exchanger **28** may function as a condenser where heat is released from the refrigerant to ambient air, and the heat exchanger **30** may function as an evaporator where the refrigerant absorbs heat to cool an air stream. In other embodiments, the HVAC unit **12** may operate in a heat pump mode where the roles of the heat exchangers **28** and **30** may be reversed. That is, the heat exchanger **28** may function as an evaporator and the heat exchanger **30** may function as a condenser. In further embodiments, the HVAC unit **12** may include a furnace for heating the air stream that is supplied to the building **10**. While the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 2 shows the HVAC unit **12** having two of the heat exchangers **28** and **30**, in other embodiments, the HVAC unit **12** may include one heat exchanger or more than two heat exchangers.

(24) The heat exchanger **30** is located within a compartment **31** that separates the heat exchanger **30** from the heat exchanger **28**. Fans **32** draw air from the environment through the heat exchanger **28**. Air may be heated and/or cooled as the air flows through the heat exchanger **28** before being

released back to the environment surrounding the HVAC unit **12**. A blower assembly **34**, powered by a motor **36**, draws air through the heat exchanger **30** to heat or cool the air. The heated or cooled air may be directed to the building **10** by the ductwork **14**, which may be connected to the HVAC unit **12**. Before flowing through the heat exchanger **30**, the conditioned air flows through one or more filters **38** that may remove particulates and contaminants from the air. In certain embodiments, the filters **38** may be disposed on the air intake side of the heat exchanger **30** to prevent contaminants from contacting the heat exchanger **30**.

(25) The HVAC unit **12** also may include other equipment for implementing the thermal cycle. Compressors **42** increase the pressure and temperature of the refrigerant before the refrigerant enters the heat exchanger **28**. The compressors **42** may be any suitable type of compressors, such as scroll compressors, rotary compressors, screw compressors, or reciprocating compressors. In some embodiments, the compressors **42** may include a pair of hermetic direct drive compressors arranged in a dual stage configuration **44**. However, in other embodiments, any number of the compressors **42** may be provided to achieve various stages of heating and/or cooling. As may be noted, additional equipment and devices may be included in the HVAC unit **12**, such as a solid-core filter drier, a drain pan, a disconnect switch, an economizer, pressure switches, phase monitors, and humidity sensors, among other things.

(26) The HVAC unit **12** may receive power through a terminal block **46**. For example, a high voltage power source may be connected to the terminal block **46** to power the equipment. The operation of the HVAC unit **12** may be governed or regulated by a control board **48**. The control board **48** may include control circuitry connected to a thermostat, sensors, and alarms. One or more of these components may be referred to herein separately or collectively as the control device **16**. The control circuitry may be configured to control operation of the equipment, provide alarms, and monitor safety switches. Wiring **49** may connect the control board **48** and the terminal block **46** to the equipment of the HVAC unit **12**.

(27) FIG. 3 illustrates a residential heating and cooling system **50**, also in accordance with present techniques. The residential heating and cooling system **50** may provide heated and cooled air to a residential structure, as well as provide outside air for ventilation and provide improved indoor air quality (IAQ) through devices such as ultraviolet lights and air filters. In the illustrated embodiment, the residential heating and cooling system **50** is a split HVAC system. In general, a residence **52** conditioned by a split HVAC system may include refrigerant conduits **54** that operatively couple the indoor unit **56** to the outdoor unit **58**. The indoor unit **56** may be positioned in a utility room, an attic, a basement, and so forth. The outdoor unit **58** is typically situated adjacent to a side of residence **52** and is covered by a shroud to protect the system components and to prevent leaves and other debris or contaminants from entering the unit. The refrigerant conduits **54** transfer refrigerant between the indoor unit **56** and the outdoor unit **58**, typically transferring primarily liquid refrigerant in one direction and primarily vaporized refrigerant in an opposite direction.

(28) When the system shown in FIG. 3 is operating as an air conditioner, a heat exchanger **60** in the outdoor unit **58** serves as a condenser for re-condensing vaporized refrigerant flowing from the indoor unit **56** to the outdoor unit **58** via one of the refrigerant conduits **54**. In these applications, a heat exchanger **62** of the indoor unit functions as an evaporator. Specifically, the heat exchanger **62** receives liquid refrigerant, which may be expanded by an expansion device, and evaporates the refrigerant before returning it to the outdoor unit **58**.

(29) The outdoor unit **58** draws environmental air through the heat exchanger **60** using a fan **64** and expels the air above the outdoor unit **58**. When operating as an air conditioner, the air is heated by the heat exchanger **60** within the outdoor unit **58** and exits the unit at a temperature higher than it entered. The indoor unit **56** includes a blower or fan **66** that directs air through or across the indoor heat exchanger **62**, where the air is cooled when the system is operating in air conditioning mode. Thereafter, the air is passed through ductwork **68** that directs the air to the residence **52**. The overall

system operates to maintain a desired temperature as set by a system controller. When the temperature sensed inside the residence **52** is higher than the set point on the thermostat, or the set point plus a small amount, the residential heating and cooling system **50** may become operative to refrigerate additional air for circulation through the residence **52**. When the temperature reaches the set point, or the set point minus a small amount, the residential heating and cooling system **50** may stop the refrigeration cycle temporarily.

(30) The residential heating and cooling system **50** may also operate as a heat pump. When operating as a heat pump, the roles of heat exchangers **60** and **62** are reversed. That is, the heat exchanger **60** of the outdoor unit **58** will serve as an evaporator to evaporate refrigerant and thereby cool air entering the outdoor unit **58** as the air passes over the outdoor heat exchanger **60**. The indoor heat exchanger **62** will receive a stream of air blown over it and will heat the air by condensing the refrigerant.

(31) In some embodiments, the indoor unit **56** may include a furnace system **70**. For example, the indoor unit **56** may include the furnace system **70** when the residential heating and cooling system **50** is not configured to operate as a heat pump. The furnace system **70** may include a burner assembly and heat exchanger, among other components, inside the indoor unit **56**. Fuel is provided to the burner assembly of the furnace **70** where it is mixed with air and combusted to form combustion products. The combustion products may pass through tubes or piping in a heat exchanger, separate from heat exchanger **62**, such that air directed by the blower **66** passes over the tubes or pipes and extracts heat from the combustion products. The heated air may then be routed from the furnace system **70** to the ductwork **68** for heating the residence **52**.

(32) FIG. **4** is an embodiment of a vapor compression system **72** that can be used in any of the systems described above. The vapor compression system **72** may circulate a refrigerant through a circuit starting with a compressor **74**. The circuit may also include a condenser **76**, an expansion valve(s) or device(s) **78**, and an evaporator **80**. The vapor compression system **72** may further include a control panel **82** that has an analog to digital (A/D) converter **84**, a microprocessor **86**, a non-volatile memory **88**, and/or an interface board **90**. The control panel **82** and its components may function to regulate operation of the vapor compression system **72** based on feedback from an operator, from sensors of the vapor compression system **72** that detect operating conditions, and so forth.

(33) In some embodiments, the vapor compression system **72** may use one or more of a variable speed drive (VSDs) **92**, a motor **94**, the compressor **74**, the condenser **76**, the expansion valve or device **78**, and/or the evaporator **80**. The motor **94** may drive the compressor **74** and may be powered by the variable speed drive (VSD) **92**. The VSD **92** receives alternating current (AC) power having a particular fixed line voltage and fixed line frequency from an AC power source, and provides power having a variable voltage and frequency to the motor **94**. In other embodiments, the motor **94** may be powered directly from an AC or direct current (DC) power source. The motor **94** may include any type of electric motor that can be powered by a VSD or directly from an AC or DC power source, such as a switched reluctance motor, an induction motor, an electronically commutated permanent magnet motor, or another suitable motor.

(34) The compressor **74** compresses a refrigerant vapor and delivers the vapor to the condenser **76** through a discharge passage. In some embodiments, the compressor **74** may be a centrifugal compressor. The refrigerant vapor delivered by the compressor **74** to the condenser **76** may transfer heat to a fluid passing across the condenser **76**, such as ambient or environmental air **96**. The refrigerant vapor may condense to a refrigerant liquid in the condenser **76** as a result of thermal heat transfer with the environmental air **96**. The liquid refrigerant from the condenser **76** may flow through the expansion device **78** to the evaporator **80**.

(35) The liquid refrigerant delivered to the evaporator **80** may absorb heat from another air stream, such as a supply air stream **98** provided to the building **10** or the residence **52**. For example, the supply air stream **98** may include ambient or environmental air, return air from a building, or a

combination of the two. The liquid refrigerant in the evaporator **80** may undergo a phase change from the liquid refrigerant to a refrigerant vapor. In this manner, the evaporator **80** may reduce the temperature of the supply air stream **98** via thermal heat transfer with the refrigerant. Thereafter, the vapor refrigerant exits the evaporator **80** and returns to the compressor **74** by a suction line to complete the cycle.

(36) In some embodiments, the vapor compression system **72** may further include a reheat coil in addition to the evaporator **80**. For example, the reheat coil may be positioned downstream of the evaporator relative to the supply air stream **98** and may reheat the supply air stream **98** when the supply air stream **98** is overcooled to remove humidity from the supply air stream **98** before the supply air stream **98** is directed to the building **10** or the residence **52**.

(37) It should be noted that any of the features described herein may be incorporated with the HVAC unit **12**, the residential heating and cooling system **50**, or other HVAC systems.

Additionally, while the features disclosed herein are described in the context of embodiments that directly heat and cool a supply air stream provided to a building or other load, embodiments of the present disclosure may be applicable to other HVAC systems as well. For example, the features described herein may be applied to mechanical cooling systems, free cooling systems, chiller systems, or other heat pump or refrigeration applications.

(38) An HVAC system may have multiple sections and/or chambers. As used herein, a section or chamber of the HVAC system or unit may be any suitable volume or enclosure of the HVAC system through which an air flow is directed. For example, the section may have heat exchanger tubes through which a working fluid flows. The air flow may be directed through the section and across the heat exchanger tubes, thereby exchanging heat with the working fluid. The section may also include baffles configured to direct the air flow directly across the heat exchanger tubes to enable a greater amount of heat exchange between the air flow and the working fluid. In some embodiments, the section may include a first set of heat exchanger tubes and a second set of heat exchanger tubes. The baffles may extend generally between the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes along a flow direction of the air flow. In particular, the baffles may be arranged so as to block the air flow from bypassing the second set of heat exchanger tubes and/or to guide the air flow from the first set of heat exchanger tubes to the second set of heat exchanger tubes. Thus, the baffles may increase an amount of the air flow directed across the second set of heat exchanger tubes, thereby increasing an amount of heat exchanged between the air flow and the working fluid directed through the second set of heat exchanger tubes. As a result, the baffles may improve a performance, such as an efficiency, of the HVAC system to condition the air flow.

(39) FIG. 5 is a schematic of an embodiment of an HVAC unit **100**. In some embodiments, the HVAC unit **100** may be implemented in the building **10** to condition an air flow and supply the conditioned air flow throughout the building **10**. For example, the HVAC unit **100** may be similar to the HVAC unit **12** and may include components similarly described above with reference to the vapor compression system **72** to condition the air flow. In some embodiments, the HVAC unit **100** includes baffles **102** disposed therein and configured to direct the air flow through the HVAC unit **100**, in accordance with the present techniques. The illustrated HVAC unit **100** includes a housing **104** that contains various components, including a filter **106**, an evaporator **108**, and a blower **110**. The blower **110** may draw an air flow into the housing **104** via an intake section **111** of the HVAC unit **100**. The blower **110** directs the air flow across the filter **106** and the evaporator **108**, as indicated by arrow **112**. The air flow is then forced into a heating section **114** of the HVAC unit **100**, which may be a plenum, chamber, or other volume of the housing **104**. The heating section **114** includes a furnace **116** having heat exchanger tubes. Particularly, the furnace **116** has a first set of heat exchanger tubes **118** and a second set of heat exchanger tubes **120**. The heating section **114** also includes the baffles **102**, which are configured to direct the air flow across the furnace **116**, and more particularly across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **120**, before the air flow is

discharged from the HVAC unit **100**. The configuration and operation of the baffles **102** are described in further detail below. Additionally, it should be appreciated that the baffles **102** disclosed herein may be utilized with other sections or portions of an HVAC system other than the heating section **114**.

(40) FIG. **6** is a schematic of an embodiment of the heating section **114** of the HVAC system **100**. For example, the heating section **114** may be a portion of the HVAC unit **12**, the residential heating and cooling system **50**, or any other suitable HVAC system configured to condition an air flow. The heating section **114** includes a first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and a second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**, and an air flow **156** may be directed through the heating section **114** across the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. In some embodiments, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may each be components of a furnace that configured to heat the air flow **156** within the heating section **114**. As an example, a working fluid, such as combustion products, may circulate through the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. Furthermore, the air flow **156** may be directed in a flow direction **158** of an air flow path, such as along a vertical axis **159**, so as to flow across the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. As a result, heat may be transferred from the combustion products to the air flow **156** passing across the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**, thereby heating the air flow **156**.

(41) In some implementations, the heating section **114** may have a first opening **160**, such as a bottom discharge opening, through which the air flow **156** may be discharged from the heating section **114** along the vertical axis **159**. Additionally or alternatively, the heating section **114** may have a second opening **162**, such as a side discharge opening, through which the air flow **156** may be discharged from the heating section **114** along a lateral axis **164**. For instance, the heating section **114** may also be a discharge section of the HVAC system **100**, and the air flow **156** may be a supply air flow. The first opening **160** and/or the second opening **162** may therefore discharge the air flow **156** toward a space, such as a room of a structure, conditioned by the HVAC system **100**. By way of example, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may heat the air flow **156** to a comfortable or desirable temperature, and the air flow **156** may be discharged to the space to condition the space. In additional or alternative embodiments, the heating section **114** may be another suitable section of the HVAC system **100**, and the first opening **160** and/or the second opening **162** may discharge the air flow **156** to another part of the HVAC system **100**, such as into ductwork and/or a different section of the HVAC system **100** for further conditioning of the air flow **156**.

(42) The first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may be positioned in a series arrangement relative to the flow direction **158** of the air flow **156** through the heating section **114**. Therefore, as the air flow **156** is directed through the air flow path, the air flow **156** may be heated by the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and then by the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In addition, the heating section **114** may include walls **166**, such as lateral or side walls, to enclose the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** and define the air flow path. That is, the walls **166** may generally direct the air flow **156** across the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and then across the second heat exchanger tubes **154**. By way of example, the air flow **156** may flow across the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and/or through first gaps **168** formed between the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and the walls **166**. The air flow **156** may then flow across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** and/or through second gaps **170** formed between the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** and the walls **166**. The air flow **156** may then be discharged out of the heating section **114** via the first and/or second openings **160**, **162**.

(43) In some circumstances, the air flow **156** may flow from the first gaps **168** directly toward the second gaps **170**. In other words, a portion of the air flow **156** may not flow toward and across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. Accordingly, the heating section **114** includes deflector baffles **172** configured to direct the air flow **156** from the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152**

toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. Thus, the air flow **156** may flow across, rather than bypass, the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. By way of example, the deflector baffles **172** may be positioned between the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**, such as downstream of the first gaps **168** and upstream of the second gaps **170** with respect to the flow direction **158**. In this way, the deflector baffles **172**, the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152**, and the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** may be offset from one another along the flow direction **158**.

(44) In some embodiments, each of the deflector baffles **172** may be coupled to a respective inner surface **174** of one of the walls **166**. For example, each deflector baffle **172** may have a respective flange **176** configured to couple to one of the inner surfaces **174**, such as via a mechanical fastener, a weld, an adhesive, a tab, a hook, another suitable method, or any combination thereof. Each flange **176** may be coupled to one of the walls **166** adjacent to one of the first gaps **168**, and each deflector baffle **172** may also have a deflecting surface **178** extending from the respective flange **176** of the deflector baffle **172**. As such, the deflector baffles **172** may partially block the second gaps **170** along the flow direction **158**. Further, the deflecting surfaces **178** may be angled at a respective acute angle **180** relative to the walls **166** such that the deflecting surfaces **178** extend partially in a downstream direction toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. Therefore, the acute angle **180** may be based on an arrangement or position of the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and/or the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** within the air flow path. For example, a magnitude of the acute angle **180** may be selected based on a distance between the first and second set of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**, a position of the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** relative to the walls **166**, a position of the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** relative to the walls **166**, and the like. By way of example, each acute angle **180** may be between 30 degrees and 80 degrees, such as 45 degrees or 60 degrees, so as to guide the air flow **156** from the first gaps **168** toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. As a result, a greater portion of the air flow **156** may flow across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In this way, the deflector baffles **172** may increase an amount of the air flow **156** heated by the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In the illustrated embodiment, the deflecting surfaces **178** are generally flat or planar, but in additional or alternative embodiments, the deflecting surfaces **178** may each have a different, suitable geometry, such as a curved or a step-like shape.

(45) In FIG. **6**, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** are approximately centered between the walls **166**. Thus, the heating section **114** may have two deflector baffles **172** that are similar or approximately identical in shape and that are positioned on opposite sides of the air flow path to direct and distribute the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In additional or alternative embodiments, the first and/or second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may be positioned in another manner within the heating section **114**. For instance, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may be positioned offset with one another and/or off center between the walls **166**. As a result, the heating section **114** may have a different number of deflector baffles **172** and/or the deflector baffles **172** may be positioned in a different manner within the heating section **114** to direct the air flow **156** in a suitable manner across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. Moreover, in certain embodiments, the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** has a different number of heat exchanger tubes as that of the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In an example, the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** has nine heat exchanger tubes, and the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** has five heat exchanger tubes. Further still, although the heating section **114** includes deflector baffles **172** positioned between the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** in the illustrated embodiment, in additional or alternative embodiments, the heating section **114** may include deflector baffles **172** positioned upstream of the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** so as to partially block the first gaps **168** and to guide the air flow **156** across the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152**. Thus, the deflector baffles **172** may increase an amount of heat exchanged between the air flow **156** and the refrigerant

flowing through the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152**.

(46) FIG. 7 is a schematic of an embodiment of the heating section **114** having deflector baffles **172** that are adjustable within the heating section **114**. By way of example, the deflector baffles **172** may be actuated based on an operating status of the first and/or second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. For instance, if the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** are in operation, such as during a heating mode or reheating mode of the HVAC system **100**, the deflector baffles **172** may be in a first or deployed position within the air flow path. That is, in the deployed position, the deflector baffles **172** extend from the walls **166** toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**, as illustrated in FIG. 7, thereby overlapping with the second gaps **170** in the flow direction **158** and at least partially blocking air flow through the second gaps **170** in the flow direction **158**. Thus, while the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** are in operation to heat the air flow **156**, the deflector baffles **172** direct the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** so as to increase an amount of heat exchanged between the air flow **156** and the working fluid flowing through the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**.

(47) However, if the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** are not in operation, such as during a cooling mode of the HVAC system **100**, the deflector baffles **172** may be moved to a second or retracted position. In the second position, the deflector baffles **172** may extend along, or may be oriented substantially parallel with, the walls **166** instead of extending away from the walls **166**. As such, the deflector baffles **172** do not block the second gaps **170** in the second position. Therefore, the air flow **156** may flow through the second gaps **170** generally unimpeded. In other words, the air flow **156** may flow from the first gaps **168** to the second gaps **170** without being directed across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. For this reason, the air flow **156** may be discharged from the heating section **114** at a higher flow rate while the deflector baffles **172** are in the second position as compared to when the deflector baffles **172** are in the first or deployed position. When the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** are not in operation, moving the deflector baffles **172** to the second position may increase an efficiency of the HVAC system **100** directing the air flow **156** through the heating section **114**. For example, the blower **110** or another component forcing the air flow **156** through the heating section **114** may operate at a lower operating mode to achieve a desired flow rate of the air flow **156** through the heating section **114**, thereby reducing a cost associated with operating the HVAC system **100**.

(48) Each of the deflector baffles **172** may be coupled to a respective actuator **200** configured to actuate one of the deflector baffles **172**. For example, when the actuators **200** receive power, such as electrical power, the actuators **200** may impart a force to move the deflector baffles **172** in a first direction **202** to the retracted position along the walls **166**. In some embodiments, each deflector baffle **172** may have a hinge configured to pivotably couple the deflecting surface **178** to the wall **166**. The hinge may enable the deflecting surface **178** to rotate relative to the wall **166** in the first direction **202** to the retracted position. When power is interrupted, such that the actuators **200** do not receive power, the actuators **200** may not impart a force on the deflector baffles **172**, and the deflector baffles **172** may move in a second direction **204**, such as about the hinge, to the deployed position. For example, a biasing element, such as a spring, may be positioned between the deflector baffles **172** and the walls **166** to bias the deflector baffles **172** toward the deployed position when the actuators **200** are not powered to retract the deflector baffles **172**.

(49) In the illustrated embodiment, the actuators **200** are positioned outside of the heating section **114**, such as against an outer surface **206** of the walls **166**, rather than within the heating section **114** between the walls **166**. Thus, the actuators **200** are positioned outside of the air flow path and do not impede a flow of the air flow **156**. To this end, the actuators **200** may include a mechanism, such as a linkage system, that extends through the walls **166** so as to couple to the deflector baffles **172**. In additional or alternative embodiments, the actuators **200** may be positioned in any suitable position to operate the deflector baffles **172**, such as against the inner surfaces **174** of the walls **166**.

(50) In some embodiments, the HVAC system **100** may include a controller **208** configured to

enable the actuators **200** to move the deflector baffles **172**. The controller **208** may have a memory **210** and a processor **212**. The memory **210** may be a mass storage device, a flash memory device, removable memory, or any other non-transitory computer-readable medium that includes instructions for the processor **212** to execute. The memory **210** may also include volatile memory such as randomly accessible memory (RAM) and/or non-volatile memory such as hard disc memory, flash memory, and/or other suitable memory formats. The processor **212** may execute the instructions stored in the memory **210**, such as operation of the HVAC system **100** in various operating modes. In the illustrated embodiment, the controller **208** is communicatively coupled to a power source **214**, which may be configured to supply power to various components of the HVAC system **100**. For example, the controller **208** is configured to output a signal to the power source **214**, which may be configured to transmit electrical power upon receiving the signal. By way of example, the power source **214** may be electrically coupled to a fan **216** of the condenser **76** of the HVAC system **100** and to the actuators **200**. Thus, the power source **214** may provide electrical power to the fan **216** to direct air across the condenser **76** and cool refrigerant flowing through the condenser **76** and/or to the actuators **200** to move the deflector baffles **172** to the second or retracted position.

(51) The fan **216** and the actuators **200** may be electrically coupled in series with the power source **214**. In other words, the electrical power provided by the power source **214** may flow to the fan **216** and then to the actuators **200**, as shown in FIG. 7, or alternatively, the electrical power may flow to the actuators **200** and then to the fan **216**. As a result, when the controller **208** transmits the signal to the power source **214**, both the fan **216** and the actuators **200** may be activated. Conversely, when the controller **208** does not transmit the signal to the power source **214**, neither the fan **216** nor the actuators **200** may be activated. For example, in a first mode of the HVAC system **100**, it may be desirable to cool refrigerant flowing through the condenser **76**. After the refrigerant is cooled at the condenser **76**, the cooled refrigerant may be placed in a heat exchange relationship with the air flow **156** at another section of the HVAC system **100** so as to cool the air flow **156**. Thus, the first mode may be a cooling mode of the HVAC system **100**. However, in the first mode, it may not be desirable to heat the air flow **156**. Therefore, a working fluid may not flow through the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. In other words, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may not be operational in the first mode, and it therefore may not be desirable to direct the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** due to fluidic restrictions imposed on the air flow **156** by the non-operating second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. For this reason, in the first mode, the controller **208** enables the power source **214** to provide power to operate the fan **216** to cool the refrigerant in the condenser **76** and to operate the actuators **200** to move the deflector baffles **172** in the first direction **202** to the retracted position. As such, the refrigerant may cool the air flow **156** and the air flow **156** may be directed through the heating section **114** at a greater flow rate in the first mode.

(52) In a second mode of the HVAC system **100**, it may not be desirable to cool the refrigerant flowing through the condenser **76** and/or it may be desirable to heat the air flow **156** with a working fluid flowing through the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. Thus, in the second mode, it may be desirable to increase an amount of the air flow **156** directed across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** to increase heating of the air flow **156**. Thus, the second mode may be a heating mode of the HVAC system **100**, in which electrical power is not supplied to either the fan **216** or the actuators **200**. That is, in the second mode, the power source **214** does not provide power to the fan **216** or the actuators **200**, and therefore neither the fan **216** nor the actuators **200** are in operation. As a result, the condenser **76** is not operated, and the deflector baffles **172** move to the deployed position to direct the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** in order to heat the air flow **156** via the working fluid flowing through the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In this way, the deflector baffles **172** increase heating of the air flow **156** in the second mode.

(53) By placing the fan **216** and the actuators **200** electrically in series, the controller **208** may transmit a single signal to the power source **214** to configure the operating mode of the HVAC system **100**, rather than transmitting separate signals to operate the fan **216** and the actuators **200** independently of one another. By way of example, in the first mode, the controller **208** may transmit the single signal to the power source **214**, thereby enabling the fan **216** to operate to cool refrigerant within the condenser **76** and enabling the actuators **200** to retract the deflector baffles **172** and increase the flow rate of the air flow **156** through the heating section **114**. Further, in the second mode, the controller **208** may not transmit the signal to the power source **214**, thereby suspending operation of the fan **216** and of the actuators alternative embodiments, the actuators **200** may be placed in series with another component of the HVAC system **100**, such as of a compressor, an evaporator, an expansion device, or any other suitable component configured to operate differently and/or in conjunction with the actuators **200** in various modes of the HVAC system **100**. Thus, the actuators **200** may be actuated according to another operating parameter or status indicative of the particular operating mode of the HVAC system **100**.

(54) FIG. **8** is a schematic of an embodiment of the heating section **114** having the deflector baffles **172** configured to move within the heating section **114**, illustrating the controller **208** as directly communicatively coupled with the actuators **200** to move the deflector baffles **172**. That is, the controller **208** may be configured to transmit respective signals to the actuators **200** to control the actuators **200** independently of other components of the HVAC system **100**. For instance, in the first mode, the controller **208** may transmit respective signals to the actuators **200** to move the deflector baffles **172** to the retracted position, thereby enabling an increase in the flow rate of the air flow **156** through the heating section **114**. The controller **208** may also transmit a separate signal to the fan **216** to cool the refrigerant within the condenser **76**. In the second mode, the controller **208** may not transmit the signals to the actuators **200**, and the deflector baffles **172** may move to the deployed position, thereby increasing an amount of the air flow **156** directed across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. Further, the controller **208** may transmit a separate signal to the fan **216** to suspend operation of the fan **216**.

(55) Moreover, the controller **208** may be configured to operate the HVAC system **100** in other modes. For example, in a third mode, the controller **208** may transmit a signal to the fan **216** to operate the fan **216** and cool refrigerant flowing through the condenser **76**, and the controller **208** may not transmit signals to the actuators **200**. Therefore, the deflector baffles **172** may move to the deployed position and direct the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** in the third mode. As an example, the third mode may be a reheat mode, in which the air flow **156** may be initially cooled, so as to remove moisture from the air flow **156**, and may then be heated to a target temperature level. Thus, the controller **208** may operate the fan **216** to cool the refrigerant flowing through the condenser **76** so as to provide cooling for the air flow **156** with the refrigerant, such as at an evaporator of the HVAC system **100**. The controller **208** may also operate the actuators **200** to deploy the deflector baffles **172**, instead of retract the deflector baffles **172**, so as to direct the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** in order to provide greater heating of the air flow **156** via the working fluid flowing through the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In this manner, the controller **208** may be configured to operate the actuators **200**, the fan **216**, and/or other components of the HVAC system **100** independently of one another and enable greater conditioning of the air flow **156**.

(56) FIG. **9** is a schematic of an embodiment of the heating section **114** in which the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** have the same number of heat exchanger tubes. In the illustrated embodiment, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** each have nine heat exchanger tubes, but in additional or alternative embodiments, the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may have any other suitable number of heat exchanger tubes. Since the number of heat exchanger tubes is greater in the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** of FIG. **9** as compared to that of the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** of FIG. **6**, the second set of heat

exchanger tubes **154** is positioned more proximate to the walls **166**. Therefore, the size of the second gaps **170** of FIG. **9** may be smaller relative to the size of the second gaps **170** of FIG. **6**. (57) As mentioned above, the orientation of the deflector baffles **172** may be based on the number of tubes of the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** to enable a desired distribution of the air flow **156** across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In some embodiments, a respective length **240** of each deflecting surface **178** of the deflector baffles **172** and/or a magnitude of the acute angles **180** may be reduced to accommodate the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154** positioned more proximate to the walls **166**. Additionally or alternatively, the respective lengths **240** may be based on the respective acute angles **180**. For example, the length **240** may be approximately 23 centimeters or 9 inches based on the acute angle being 30 degrees, approximately 15 centimeters or 6 inches based on the acute angle being 45 degrees, approximately 6.5 centimeters or 2.5 inches based on the acute angle being 60 degrees, or the like. Thus, the length **240** may be based on the orientation of the first and/or second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** within the air flow path. In further embodiments, a position of the deflector baffles **172** within the heating section **114** relative to the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** may be based on the orientation of the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In any case, the orientation of the deflector baffles **172** may be designed and/or selected in order to guide the air flow **156** effectively from the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**.

(58) FIG. **10** is a schematic of an embodiment of the heating section **114** having a side discharge configuration. For example, a first wall **166A** of the heating section **114** may have an opening **260** through which the air flow **156** is directed. In the illustrated embodiment, a blower **262** of the HVAC system **100** is configured to force or draw the air flow **156** through the opening **260** toward a second wall **166B** of the heating section **114** in a first flow direction **264**, which may be crosswise to the vertical axis **159** and/or the lateral axis **164**. That is, the first wall **166A** may be opposite the second wall **166B**, and the first flow direction **264** may be transverse, such as approximately perpendicular, to the second wall **166B**. Thus, at least a portion of the air flow **156** directed into the heating section **114** may deflect off the second wall **166B**. As an example, a first portion of the air flow **156** may deflect off the second wall **166B** generally toward the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154** in a second flow direction **266**. The first portion of the air flow **156** may flow across the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** and/or further deflect off the first wall **166A** within the heating section **114**. Moreover, a second portion of the air flow **156** may deflect off the second wall **166B** generally away from the first and second set of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**, such as in a third flow direction **268** toward a panel **270**, such as a top panel, of the heating section **114**. The second portion of the air flow **156** may then deflect off the panel **270** toward the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**. In any case, in the heating section **114** having the side discharge configuration, the air flow **156** may deflect off different surfaces, walls, and/or panels of the heating section **114** before flowing toward the first and second set of heat exchanger tubes **152**, **154**.

(59) In any case, in the side discharge configuration, the air flow **156** may not flow directly toward the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152**. However, regardless of the direction of flow of the air flow **156** through the heating section **114**, the deflector baffles **172** may effectively guide the air flow **156** from the first set of heat exchanger tubes **152** to the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. For instance, the deflector baffles **172** direct the air flow **156** from the first gaps **168** toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**. In this way, the deflector baffles **172** may increase the heating of the air flow **156**. After the air flow **156** passes across the second set of heat exchanger tubes **154**, the air flow **156** may be discharged from the heating section **114** via the first opening **160** or the second opening **162**.

(60) The present disclosure may provide one or more technical effects useful in the operation of an HVAC system. For example, the HVAC system may have a section, such as a heating section,

through which an air flow is directed. The section may include first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes through which a working fluid may flow, and the air flow may first be directed across the first set of heat exchanger tubes and then across the second set of heat exchanger tubes to exchange heat with the working fluid. Furthermore, the section may include deflector baffles positioned between the first and second sets of heat exchanger tubes. The deflector baffles may be angled so as to guide the air flow from the first set of heat exchanger tubes toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes. In this manner, the deflector baffles may increase an amount of the air flow directed across the second set of heat exchanger tubes, thereby increasing an amount of heat exchanged between the working fluid and the air flow. As a result, the deflector baffles may increase heat transfer efficiency of the HVAC system. It should be noted that the embodiments discussed herein may be retrofitted into existing HVAC systems. In other words, deflector baffles may be implemented into a section, such as a furnace or heating section, of an existing HVAC system to improve air flow and heat transfer within the section. The technical effects and technical problems in the specification are examples and are not limiting. It should be noted that the embodiments described in the specification may have other technical effects and can solve other technical problems.

(61) While only certain features and embodiments of the disclosure have been illustrated and described, many modifications and changes may occur to those skilled in the art, such as variations in sizes, dimensions, structures, shapes and proportions of the various elements, values of parameters, including temperatures and pressures, mounting arrangements, use of materials, colors, orientations, and so forth without materially departing from the novel teachings and advantages of the subject matter recited in the claims. The order or sequence of any process or method steps may be varied or re-sequenced according to alternative embodiments. It is, therefore, to be noted that the appended claims are intended to cover all such modifications and changes as fall within the true spirit of the disclosure. Furthermore, in an effort to provide a concise description of the exemplary embodiments, all features of an actual implementation may not have been described, such as those unrelated to the presently contemplated best mode of carrying out the disclosure, or those unrelated to enabling the claimed disclosure. It should be noted that in the development of any such actual implementation, as in any engineering or design project, numerous implementation specific decisions may be made. Such a development effort might be complex and time consuming, but would nevertheless be a routine undertaking of design, fabrication, and manufacture for those of ordinary skill having the benefit of this disclosure, without undue experimentation.

Claims

1. A furnace for a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system, comprising: a first set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within an air flow path of the furnace and offset from a wall of the furnace to form a first gap extending laterally between the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the wall; a second set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within the air flow path of the furnace and offset from the wall of the furnace to form a second gap extending laterally between the second set of heat exchanger tubes and the wall, wherein the second gap is larger than the first gap, wherein the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes are offset from one another relative to a direction of an air flow along the air flow path to form a rectangular-shaped space extending from the first set of heat exchanger tubes to the second set of heat exchanger tubes, and wherein the rectangular-shaped space is without heat exchanger tubes; and a deflector baffle fixedly attached to the wall, the deflector baffle comprises a flange and a deflecting surface, the flange is fixedly attached to the wall, the deflecting surface is bent relative to the flange, the deflecting surface extends away from the wall, and the deflector baffle is positioned entirely within the rectangular-shaped space and configured to direct a portion of the air flow toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes and away from the second gap.

2. The furnace of claim 1, wherein the wall is a first wall, the furnace comprises a second wall, opposite the first wall, and the rectangular-shaped space is laterally bounded by the first wall of the furnace and the second wall of the furnace.
3. The furnace of claim 2, wherein the deflector baffle is a first deflector baffle, and the furnace comprises a second deflector baffle, wherein the first deflector baffle and the second deflector baffle are positioned on opposite sides of the air flow path from one another.
4. The furnace of claim 3, wherein the second deflector baffle is attached to the second wall.
5. The furnace of claim 1, wherein the deflector baffle is rotationally fixed relative to the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes.
6. The furnace of claim 1, wherein the deflector baffle comprises: an upstream end positioned within the rectangular-shaped space; and a downstream end positioned within the rectangular-shaped space, wherein the deflecting surface extends from the upstream end to the downstream end, wherein the deflector baffle is positioned upstream of the second gap relative to the direction of the air flow along the air flow path.
7. A heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system, comprising: a furnace, comprising: a first set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within an air flow path of the furnace, wherein the first set of heat exchanger tubes is offset from a first wall of the furnace to form a first gap and offset from a second wall of the furnace to form a second gap; a second set of heat exchanger tubes positioned within the air flow path of the furnace, wherein the second set of heat exchanger tubes is offset from the first wall of the furnace to form a third gap and offset from the second wall of the furnace to form a fourth gap, each of the third gap and the fourth gap is larger than each of the first gap and the second gap, and the second set of heat exchanger tubes is offset from the first set of heat exchanger tubes along a direction of an air flow directed through the furnace; a rectangular-shaped space extending from the first set of heat exchanger tubes to the second set of heat exchanger tubes along the direction of the air flow through the furnace, wherein the rectangular-shaped space is laterally bounded by the first wall of the furnace and the second wall of the furnace relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace, and wherein the rectangular-shaped space is void of heat exchanger tubes; and a deflector baffle comprising a flange directly coupled to the first wall, wherein the deflector baffle is positioned within the rectangular-shaped space and between the first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace.
8. The HVAC system of claim 7, wherein the deflector baffle comprises a deflecting surface contained entirely within the rectangular-shaped space.
9. The HVAC system of claim 7, wherein the deflector baffle forms an acute angle with the first wall, and a magnitude of the acute angle is based on an orientation of the first set of heat exchanger tubes and/or the second set of heat exchanger tubes within the air flow path.
10. The HVAC system of claim 7, wherein the furnace comprises the first wall, the second wall, and a blower, the first wall comprises an opening, and the blower is configured to direct the air flow through the opening and toward the second wall in a second direction crosswise to the direction of the air flow through the furnace.
11. The HVAC system of claim 10, wherein the furnace comprises a third wall, the third wall comprises a discharge opening, and the furnace is configured to discharge the air flow through the discharge opening.
12. The HVAC system of claim 7, wherein the first set of heat exchanger tubes defines an upstream boundary of the rectangular-shaped space relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace, and the second set of heat exchanger tubes defines a downstream boundary of the rectangular-shaped space relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace.
13. The HVAC system of claim 7, wherein the rectangular-shaped space extends a lateral dimension from the first wall of the furnace to the second wall of the furnace, relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace, and the rectangular-shaped space extends between the

first set of heat exchanger tubes and the second set of heat exchanger tubes across an entirety of the lateral dimension.

14. A furnace for a heating, ventilation, and/or air conditioning (HVAC) system, comprising: a first set of heat exchanger tubes offset from a first wall of the furnace and offset from a second wall of the furnace to form a first set of gaps; a second set of heat exchanger tubes offset from the first wall of the furnace and offset from the second wall of the furnace to form a second set of gaps, wherein the first wall and the second wall are positioned on opposite sides of the furnace, and each gap of the second set of gaps is larger than each gap of the first set of gaps; a rectangular-shaped space, wherein the first set of heat exchanger tubes defines an upstream boundary of the rectangular-shaped space relative to a direction of an air flow through the furnace, the second set of heat exchanger tubes defines a downstream boundary of the rectangular-shaped space relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace, the first wall and the second wall define lateral boundaries of the rectangular-shaped space relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace, and the rectangular-shaped space is without heat exchanger tubes; and a baffle fixedly attached to the first wall and extending from the first wall, wherein the baffle comprises a flange and a deflecting surface, the flange is fixedly attached to the first wall, the deflecting surface is bent relative to the flange, the deflecting surface extends away from the first wall, the baffle is positioned entirely within the rectangular-shaped space, and the baffle is configured to direct a portion of the air flow toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes and away from a gap of the second set of gaps.

15. The furnace of claim 14, wherein the baffle comprises an upstream end attached to the first wall and a downstream end, opposite the upstream end, wherein the downstream end is positioned within the rectangular-shaped space upstream of the second set of heat exchanger tubes, relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace.

16. The HVAC system of claim 7, wherein the deflector baffle is positioned upstream of the third gap relative to the direction of the air flow through the furnace and configured to redirect the air flow away from the third gap and toward the second set of heat exchanger tubes.
